

# 东方译场译文标准

佛法翻译的两大标准：**准确性和可读性**

《东方智慧视角，全球时代之需》

上济下群大和尚对多语言交流中心的开示

2024.02.04

……翻译的准确性很重要。这里讲的准确性，主要是在内容层面上保证准确，而不在于对每个词进行精准翻译。如何做到内容准确？这需要对每篇文章进行学习、领会、交流，乃至用八步骤三种禅修来完成真正的领会。能把内在精神领会到位，翻译时就能自由表达，可以用这个概念，也可以用那个概念。这就像法师们弘法一样，你能吃透佛法的精神，怎么讲都可以，但如果自己并未真正理解，无论用什么词、做怎样的解释，都会担心出错。所以，翻译不是单纯地完成词语转换，否则每天都在抠字眼，就会抠得很辛苦。翻译中用词讲究当然也重要，但首先还是要立足于领会每篇文章的内涵，一定要弄清楚它到底要表达什么思想，又是从哪几个方面表达的。

另外就是可读性，要符合外国人所喜欢的阅读习惯。如果我们自认为翻译得很好，但外国人读着不习惯，那再好也没用。

总之，我们虽然讲了很多道理，但译场的流程和布局主要考虑两大要点，一是可读性，二是准确性。这是最重要的两点。

# 准确性

四种常见错译：

1. 概念错译
2. 不忠实原文，过度发挥
3. 语气错误
4. 缺乏调整，过于直译

编译部肩负着法脉传承的重要使命，因此，法的完整、准确、透彻的转述是我们的首要任务。《大般涅槃经》中云：“是诸恶人，虽复诵读如是经典，灭除如来深密要义，安置世间庄严文饰无义之语，抄前著后，抄后著前，前后著中，中著前后。当知如是，诸恶比丘是魔伴侣。”

以下是一些错译的例子，供菩萨们参考。

---

## 概念错译

原文：真心，即如来藏的体系，认为“一切众生皆有佛性”。

原译文：The system of the true mind, or of the Tathagatagarbha, **proposes** that “all sentient beings have Buddha-nature.

修改后：The system of the true mind, or of the Tathagatagarbha, **states** that “all sentient beings have Buddha-nature.

**Proposes** 是提出、提议、建议。但是“一切众生皆有佛性”是佛陀的体征，为众生开显真相。所以这里应调整为 **states** 或 **teaches**.

原文：所以佛教特别重视亲近善知识，甚至把善知识称为“全梵行”。

原译文：Therefore, Buddhism highly values being close to compassionate teachers, even referring to them as “fully virtuous beings.”

调整后：Therefore, Buddhism highly values being close to virtuous teachers, referring to them as the “source of all our pure cultivation and its merit.”

善知识：善知识的佛法常规译法包括：good friend, spiritual guide, religious mentor(*Princeton Dictionary of Buddhism*)。当然，类似的 virtuous friend, virtuous teacher 也是可以的。但 compassionate teacher 就是错译了。

全梵行：根据导师的开示，全梵行的意思是“一切修行功德都来自善知识”。

这个词出自《增一阿含经》。“尔时阿难，白世尊言：所谓善知识者，即是半梵行之人，事将引善道以至无为。佛告阿难：勿作是言，言善知识者，即是半梵行之人，所以然者？夫善知识之人，即是全梵行之人。”

Fully virtuous friend 是错译，应译为 the source of all our pure cultivation and its merit.

Tips: 如遇不理解的佛教术语，需和您的传帮带菩萨交流讨论。非常困难法义，也可以请东方译场的特邀佛法顾问上定下如法师解释。

---

## 不忠实原文

原文：意识错误认识的境界，为遍计所执相。

过度翻译：The fabricated or imaginary nature is the world that emerges from our mind's continuous conceptual elaboration, thus imposing images upon all phenomena, resulting in a false image of the world that appears in our mind.

过度删减：The fabricated or imaginary nature shows us a fake world.

忠实翻译：The fabricated or imaginary nature, is the world as falsely processed by our consciousness.

---

## 语气错译

原文：应该说，我也是其中的重要参与者。据统计，在导航建设过程中，我的相关讲话多达 76 万字。

原译文：Let me also mention that I was a very important participant in this endeavor. According to statistics, my speeches related to the navigation's development totaled 760,000 words.

调整后：I was one of the key participants in this endeavor. According to statistics, my speeches related to the navigation's development totaled 760,000 words.

这里的语气突出自我重要感，不符合导师的说话方式。

---

## 过于直译，缺乏调整

原文：首先，我长期从事唯识研究，修学并讲解过玄奘三藏翻译的经论，一直以来，对他有份特别的情感。

原译文：First, I've long been immersed in Yogacara studies, having both practiced and taught the scriptures that Master Xuanzang translated. Over time, I've developed a **deep affection for him**.

调整后：First, I've long been immersed in Yogacara studies, having both practiced and taught the Buddhist texts that Master Xuanzang translated. I've always felt a **deep reverence and connection to him**.

原文：孔子将朋友分为益友和损友，还有孟母三迁的典故，都是说明交友的重要性。

原译文：Confucius categorized friends as either beneficial or harmful, and **Mencius' mother moving three times** underscores the importance of choosing friends.

调整后：Confucius categorized friends as either beneficial or harmful. **Mencius' mother moved three times to find him the best learning environment**. Both underscore the importance of choosing friends.

若不略加解释，读者则无法理解 Mencius' mother moving three times 和交善友的关系。

# 可读性

可读性四技巧：

- 1. 言简意赅
- 2. 用简单易懂的短语
- 3. 多用主动语态
- 4. 避免把动词变为名词

---

## 言简意赅

在佛教翻译中，简洁尤为重要。佛教教法深奥微妙，繁琐的语言会让读者难以理解导师想要传达的深意。

“Vigorous writing is concise. A sentence should contain no unnecessary words, a paragraph no unnecessary sentences, for the same reason that a drawing should have no unnecessary lines and a machine no unnecessary parts. This requires not that the writer make all his sentences short, or that he avoid all detail and treat his subjects only in outline, but that every word tell.”

— William Strunk Jr., *The Elements of Style*

| 不简练                                | 简练          |
|------------------------------------|-------------|
| The question as to whether         | Whether     |
| There is no doubt but that         | no doubt    |
| He is a man who                    | he          |
| In a hasty manner                  | hastily     |
| The reason why is that             | because     |
| The fact that he had not succeeded | his failure |

翻译中的例子：

原文：这项运动能够帮助我们放松心情，提升觉知力。《太极正念球四折页》

原译文：This exercise can **bring calm** to the mind and **improve the power** of awareness.

调整后：This exercise can **calm** the mind and **improve** awareness.

---

### 用简单易懂的短语

简明语言的原则之一是使用短句，避免长句。许多习作手册都提出句子长短的建议。根据美国证券和交易委员会编写的写作手册，句子长度应为 15-20 个单词，句子要长短结合，长句不超过三项信息

李长栓《非文学翻译理论与实践》

复杂繁琐的译文：If you could let me have the latest typed version of the form in the next seven days, whereupon I suggest we meet her on 19 December to finalize the text so that you could then give me an estimate of the cost of producing a typeset proof.

简练易读的译文：Please let me have the latest typed version of the form in the next seven days. I suggest we meet here on 19 December to finalize the text. You could then give me an estimate of the cost of producing a typeset proof.

翻译中的例子：

原文：很多人从未考虑过这些。

原译文：For many individuals, they have never taken the time to give thought or consideration to these matters.

调整后：Many have never asked these questions.

原文：这种面对将让人多么沮丧，多么无所适从啊。

原译文：A realization, when manifested, will result in feelings of being lost and disheartened.

调整后：This realization will leave us feeling lost and disheartened.

---

## 多用主动语态

主动语态简短、清楚；被动语态较长，有时意思不清。主动语态应占 90%。在 10% 的情况下，使用被动语态更合适。

李长栓《非文学翻译理论与实践》

被动：There were a great number of dead leaves lying on the ground.

调整为主动：Dead leaves covered the ground

被动：It was not long before she was very sorry that she had said what she had.

调整为主动：She soon repented her words

翻译中的例子：

原文：对轮回做出正确解读，即 四谛法门中的“苦”和“集”

原译文：A correct understanding of samsara **is provided** by “suffering” and its “cause” in the Four Noble Truths.

调整后：“Suffering” and its “cause” in the Four Noble Truths **provide** a correct understanding of samsara.

---

## 避免把动词变为名词

Plain English is a language based on verbs. It is simple, concise, vigorous, and above all, clear. *Chinglish* is a language based on nouns – vague, general, abstract nouns. It is complicated, long-winded, ponderous, and obscure.

《中式英文之鉴》

动词名词化：The **prolongation** of the existence of this temple is due to the **solidity** of its **construction**

调整后：This temple has endured because it was solidly built.

动词名词化：The age **distribution** of higher education faculty necessitates immediate **implementation** of innovative early retirement programs.

调整后：Because there are so many older teachers in colleges and universities, we should immediately introduce innovative programs for early retirement.

原文：佛法修行帮助我们观照内心，调整心行，改造人生

原译文：Buddhist cultivation enables the **observation of the mind**, the **adjustment of our mental actions**, and the **transformation of our lives**.

调整后：Buddhist cultivation helps us **observe the mind**, **adjust our mental actions**, and **transform our lives**.

原文：在甘露别院，每个人都可以在禅意的生活里，开启生命更丰盈的层面，完成生命的教育与成长，邂逅那个更美好的自己。

原译文：Practicing at the Amrita Retreat Center allows for the **embracing** of a Chan-inspired lifestyle, the **enriching** of lives, and the **discovery** of a more beautiful self.

调整后：At the Amrita Retreat Center, you can **embrace** a Chan-inspired lifestyle, **enrich** your lives, and **discover** a more beautiful self.